

Thirst for FOSS at the Job Market!

With FOSS growing by leaps and bounds because of the supportive IT landscape, there is a hard-to-quench thirst for FOSS experts. So don those FOSS training boots to climb higher up the career graph!

A decade ago, Novell Netware was a synonym for networks just like Windows was for operating systems. Expressions like "I have Netware, but I am not too sure of whether I have a network," weren't unheard of. It was a monopoly then. Today, FOSS/Linux has placed freedom of choice back into the hands of companies using technology. And the recent recession has helped to change the general perception about FOSS. The result is a heavy demand for FOSS experts from independent software vendors, SMEs, the government, and technology-oriented companies in the embedded device, mobile and netbook markets.

Elaborating on the demand for FOSS experts across India, Alok Srivastava, chairman, Network Nuts, a Delhi-based IT

training company, says: "During the last one year, I have seen tremendous growth in the number of people/companies coming for FOSS training. We have enrolled many who've been given a deadline of one month to get themselves trained on the Linux server because the company cannot afford to buy a Windows/Solaris box. The 50-55 per cent growth that the FOSS training sector saw last year speaks loud and clear of the growing demand for FOSS experts."

Advantage FOSS

But before taking the FOSS plunge, analysis of whether FOSS truly gives your career the much-needed push, is essential. Jaijit Bhattacharya, country director, government strategy, Sun Microsystems, says: "Organisations are getting smarter